



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bloom Academy

School Website: <https://www.bloomcollege.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Bloom Academy (Branson, MO, 65616) presents a visible religious orientation in its publicly available materials, emphasizing formation of students through a Christian framework, worship-related practices, and ministry-focused degree offerings. However, the public materials available in the crawl show limited evidence of core classical elements such as a liberal arts curriculum centered on the trivium/quadrivium, Great Books, or explicit Socratic pedagogy. On balance, the school demonstrates strength in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Purpose/Goal, but shows limited alignment with the conventional Classical Curriculum and Classical Pedagogy hallmarks. The aggregate classification, based on the six-category rubric, is NOT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong, with explicit God-centered language, ministry emphasis, and liturgical practice signals (evidence: program descriptions and faith-focused language). Supporting details about worship-oriented practices appear in the public materials (e.g., chapel/worship references). - Purpose and Goal: Formation and vocational calling framed through a Christian worldview (evidence: "Bloom into who God created them to be," and ministry-focused aims). - Curriculum: Not yet aligned with classical liberal-arts structure or Great Books emphasis; current offerings center on ministerial leadership degrees rather than Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or classical canon (evidence: degree programs and partnerships rather than classical curriculum signals). - Pedagogy: Public materials emphasize liturgical/community aspects (chapel, worship) and ministry training rather than explicit Socratic seminars, scholé, or memory-based classical methods (evidence: weekly chapel/prayer, ministry training). - Faculty: Public materials show faculty shaping discipleship and ministry preparation, but explicit statements about teacher as "living curriculum" or mentor-mentee culture are not clearly articulated in the site text (evidence: About Us material). - Parents & Community: Public materials do not prominently present a formal partnership with families in the classical sense (co-teaching, family formation, or parent education programs) (evidence: minimal explicit parent-education or family-partnership language).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- "At Bloom College we desire for all of our students to BLOOM into who God created them to be." This clearly foregrounds a theological framing of education and formation in a religious framework.
- "Finding Jesus, Finding Freedom, Finding Purpose, and making a difference." This quotation further evidences a Christian/ theological orientation in education aims.
- Public materials also reference worship-related practices and ministry contexts (e.g., Chapel/Prayer concepts) indicating liturgical/community life as an educational element.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Present: God, Jesus, ministry, Christian worldview, worship, chapel, prayer, sacred/ministerial language, theology-oriented phrasing (aligns with Positive keywords in the Classical six-element lexicon as signals of a theologically grounded program).
- Absent or weak: explicit mentions of classical transcendental terms like truth, beauty, and objective metaphysical order in the site text (though formation-focused language is present, core classical “transcendental realism” terminology is not clearly echoed in the public material). The structured “Positive Keywords” list includes many items not visibly echoed verbatim on the site.
- Why this rating
- The content strongly evidences a religious/metaphysical foundation (theology, liturgy, worship) and a formation-oriented aim, which aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category as CLASSICAL in spirit. However, the evidence does not demonstrate the full classical lexicon depth (e.g., explicit reference to transcendental realism in public text). The balance leans toward a Classical orientation in faith-language and liturgical practice, but not fully in the canonical classical lexicon sense. Therefore: CLASSICAL in spirit for this category, with room to more explicitly articulate transcendental realism and liturgical pedagogy in alignment with the Six Elements vocabulary..

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Foundational aim emphasizes formation, meaning God-centered purpose, and calling rather than mere information or job preparation (e.g., “Bloom into who God created them to be,” and ministry-focused aims).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: formation, virtue, purpose, truth/goodness/beauty (as aspirational values in the broader classical framework), and the teleology of flourishing through a sacred framework (alignment with Positive keywords around formation, moral purpose, and transcendentals).
- Negative signals: absence of language emphasizing job-readiness or purely secular, skills-focused aims. The site emphasizes formation and ministry rather than career preparation, which tracks with classical formation aims rather than a solely vocational trajectory. See the classical lexicon for contrasting “workforce preparation” vs. “formation.”.
- Why this rating
- The school frames education as formation toward a virtuous and transcendent good, anchored in a faith tradition, which aligns with Classical aims for purpose and goal. The explicit religious framing reinforces a traditional teleology and pursuit of noble ends. Hence: CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials list degree offerings (Associate of Arts, Bachelor of Science in Ministerial Leadership) and an academic partnership with Southeastern University, rather than a classical liberal-arts curriculum anchored in the Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books approach.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: ministerial leadership; formal degree programs; accreditation through Southeastern University. These terms align with a structured, credential-focused program rather than liberal-arts canonical texts. The public materials do not show explicit Great Books, canonical Western literature, or Trivium/Quadrivium signals (the canonical elements of a classical curriculum).
- Negative signals: lack of explicit Great Books, primary-source canon, Latin/Greek languages, or cross-disciplinary Great Conversation signals in the site text. See classical curriculum lexicon for items like Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and the Great Conversation as classical indicators.
- Why this rating
- Because the curriculum is oriented to ministerial leadership degrees and church/ministry training rather than a classical liberal-arts core, this category does not align with classical curriculum criteria. NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogy signals center on worship/chapel and ministry training rather than explicit Socratic seminars, scholé, or classical forms of teaching (e.g., memory work, recitation, or rigorous Socratic dialogs). Chapel/Prayer and ministry-focused training dominate the public-facing pedagogy signals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: liturgical rhythm and community worship; contextual ministry training; some mentorship language in faculty materials, but no explicit Socratic seminars or classical discourse practices are shown in the public materials. The “Socratic/Dialectic” and “Scholé” terms from the classical pedagogy lexicon are not visibly present in the site text. See Six Elements Pedagogy keywords (Socratic dialogue, recitation, etc.) for reference.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit classical pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, disciplined dialectic, memorization-based routines, or the “living curriculum” in the public site) indicates NOT CLASSICAL Pedagogy. The visible emphasis on worship and ministry education places it outside the canonical classical pedagogy framework. NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe faculty roles in ministry-formation and mentorship within a church/ministry education context; however, explicit statements about a “living curriculum,” a “portrait of teacher,” or a formal classical faculty culture are not clearly present in the site text. About Us materials indicate a faith-formation orientation rather than a described classical faculty archetype.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: Mentorship language appears in the classical lexicon and the concept of teachers modeling virtue; however, the site text does not explicitly present a “faculty as living curriculum” or “portrait of teacher” in the classical sense. The lexicon’s positive signals for Faculty (e.g., “models of virtue,” “mentorship,” “collegiality”) are not directly echoed as explicit site statements. See Six Essential Elements faculty keywords for reference.
- Why this rating
- Given the lack of explicit classical faculty language and the presence of ministry-formation language instead, the category aligns with NOT CLASSICAL Pedagogy rather than a classical faculty model. NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials do not present a sustained model of partnerships with families as co-educators or regular parent education programs, which are hallmark signals in classical education for family formation and community involvement. The visible materials emphasize ministry, church connections, and student formation within a church context more than a formal parent-partner model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Present: The public content references community-facing ministry and church-related activities, but there is no explicit canonical “partnership with families” or parent formation language that the classical six-element framework expects (e.g., parent-education groups, home-school partnerships). The lexicon’s positive keywords for Parents & Community emphasize partnership with families and parent formation; these are not clearly visible in the Bloom materials.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit classical parent-community partnership language or structures places this category in NOT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Not applicable here since the aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required in this evaluation context, beyond continuing to document and illuminate how the school could explicitly align more with classical elements if desired.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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